COUNTRY REPORTS: LIBERIA

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# Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

## Governance

### Strategies, plans and policies

Liberia's five-year national digital strategy, Digital Liberia: Equity, Sovereignty and Innovation for a Connected Future (2025-2029), covers e-governance, data sovereignty and interoperability, but it contains no dedicated data exchange strategy and no implementation roadmap with milestones.

Delivery machinery arrived after the strategy rather than with it, in the Office for Technology and Digital Innovation and the National Digital Master Infrastructure created by executive order in April 2026. The two cross-government policies that would sit under it are both unfinished: the Ministry of Posts and Telecommunications' draft National Data Governance Policy remains unenacted, though it would introduce broader data classification and localisation requirements and recommends that machine learning be built into the government's digital roadmap with safeguards for automated decision-making, and the ministry's cybersecurity strategy carries no adoption instrument.

Sector plans are the firmer ground. Port digitisation is framed under the technological-modernisation pillar of the National Port Authority's RESET Strategic Plan 2025-2030; the Central Bank's successor financial inclusion strategy for 2026-2030, drafted after an assessment found the expired 2020-2024 one weakest on consumer protection and financial literacy, went through validation in September 2026 and is to be revised, with no launch date set; and the Liberia Telecommunications Authority announced a package of telecom reforms in July 2026. A national spatial data infrastructure is attached to the President's ARREST Agenda as an intention rather than as a funded programme, and there is still no operational digital land register.

Against that, the wider governance base is improving slowly: Liberia scores 49.1 out of 100.0 for overall governance in the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance, 26th of 54 African states and marginally below the continental average, up 3.8 points since 2014 with the pace of improvement slowing over 2019-2023 (2023).

### Legislation and regulation

The Cybercrime Act of 2025 was approved on 3 July 2026 and printed by authority on 24 July, six weeks before a ministerial announcement put its signing at 19 August, replacing a drafting-stage bill from 2021 as the text on record. The government's own cybersecurity strategy had committed it to reviewing and adopting that draft. The Act was first used in September 2026, when police confirmed that a man held over AI-generated images of the Vice-President was arrested under it; on 22 September a criminal court ordered him released from police custody on a habeas corpus petition, and the main opposition party said it would ask the Supreme Court to rule on the Act's constitutionality.

The legal basis for digital services rested on the Electronic Transactions Law of 2002, the National Identification Registry Act of 2011, the ICT Policy 2019-2024 and the Central Bank's 2020 electronic payment regulations, with no standalone data protection law and no cross-government data-sharing legislation, until the Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act took effect in March 2026. There is no economy-wide localisation rule, though section 9(c) of those payment regulations requires payment systems to be hosted locally or to give the Central Bank unfettered access to their data. The 2026 Public Procurement and Concessions Act requires procurement entities to use the e-GP system, making a voluntary platform statutory, while the Liberia Telecommunications Authority is rewriting the licensing regime by regulator instrument under the Telecommunications Act 2007 rather than by amending it.

The identity mandate rests on the same kind of instrument. Executive Order 147 makes enrolment in the National Biometric Identification System compulsory for all citizens and for foreign residents of 90 days or more, and makes the National Identification Number the primary identifier — an obligation created without statute, whose enforcement lapsed when issuance was suspended in August 2025. The Personal Data Protection and Privacy Bill President Boakai submitted, referred to a House committee in June 2025, was approved on 9 March 2026 and printed on 23 March.

Two legislative promises are outstanding. Executive Order 163, signed in April 2026, gives twelve months for a law institutionalising the new digital-government framework to be drafted; and the National Cybersecurity Strategy 2025-2029 set a programme of its own, running from a primary National Cybersecurity Act by Q3 2025 to an adopted operational package by Q1 2026, with cybercrime, data protection and critical infrastructure legislation and sectoral regulations due by Q4 2025.

Every deadline in that programme had passed by August 2026.

### Data protection

The gender and social protection ministry confirmed on 13 September 2026 that personal records of children in its Save the Future Project circulating on social media are authentic records it holds, that their disclosure was never authorised, and that it has opened an internal investigation; officials had posted enrolment lists of children in social protection programmes, with home addresses, to Facebook (September 2026). No action under the data-protection Act is on record.

Liberia's first privacy penalty, in June 2026, came under telecom regulation rather than its data-protection statute: the Liberia Telecommunications Authority fined Orange Liberia LRD 4 million, around US$21,900 at the time, holding the operator liable for the unauthorised issue of a customer's SIM card to a third party.

The Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act of 2024 was approved on 9 March 2026 and printed on 23 March, taking effect on publication, five months before a ministerial announcement put its signing at 19 August. It was drafted with Internews and validated in December 2024; before it, personal data was addressed only through Article 16 of the Constitution and the Electronic Transactions Law of 2002. The Act gives existing businesses a one-year transition and sets penalties including four years' imprisonment for a convicted public officer.

There is no dedicated data protection authority: the Telecommunications Authority regulates telecoms data but not personal data generally, and Liberia has signed the ECOWAS Supplementary Act obliging member states to establish a national data authority without establishing one. The Act gives an Independent Information Commissioner 24 months to issue implementing rules, and the data governance policy places complaints, investigations and remedies with the Independent Information Commission established by the Freedom of Information Act 2010; no appointment or rule under the Act is on record.

Breach reporting now has a legal route: the Cybercrime Act requires a breach to be reported to the national CERT within 72 hours. Before it, when data held by the revenue authority, the electricity corporation and the identity registry was alleged to have been breached, the inquiry came from the legislature: a House probe opened in February 2026.

Regulators have filled parts of the gap by instrument: the Satellite Communications Guidelines require satellite operators to maintain data-protection and cybersecurity compliance plans, and the Central Bank's 2020 electronic payment regulations carry consumer and data protection sections. Identity data is governed by the registry statute alone: release only to the applicant or on a court order, with no specialised tribunal overseeing it.

The rights setting is strong but slipping: Digital Freedom scores 74.6 out of 100.0, 16th of 54, down 9.0 points since 2014 (2023). Civil society reads the sequence as the wrong way round, Naymote and editorial opinion describing a country building a "digital spine" without its legal skeleton, and activists flagging security concerns over handing the identification system to a foreign operator.

### Regional collaboration

ECOWAS funds none of the regional digital programmes that bind Liberia from its own resources: the Community MTEF Budget 2026-2028 carries no disaggregated digital or ICT appropriation, and its only ICT-named programme line, "Youth Entrepreneurship in ICT", shows nil actual spend from 2024 and nil in the 2026, 2027 and 2028 estimates.

The bloc's flagship digital instrument is not public either. The ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024-2029, adopted for all member states including Liberia at Cotonou on 4 October 2024, has never been published, and its targets, budget and implementation arrangements are known only from the Commission's press release; the same ministerial required member states to ensure full implementation of the ECOWAS Roaming Regulation by all their mobile operators by the end of 2025.

Liberia's national ID card is ECOWAS-compliant in design but the ECOWAS biometric identity card has not been implemented, so cross-border recognition of the credential remains partial. The ECOWAS-World Bank WURI programme validated a cross-border interoperability strategy and a 2026 work plan in March 2026, working toward mutual recognition of national credentials across the region — a strategy rather than an operating scheme. The region it covers has meanwhile contracted: Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger severed ECOWAS and WURI ties in 2024 and have built a rival Alliance of Sahel States biometric scheme, with a common passport launched in January 2025.

On the continental instruments Liberia has acceded to neither the Budapest Convention nor the African Union's Malabo Convention, both of which its National Cybersecurity Strategy commits it to joining, and Malabo entered into force in June 2023. In October 2026 Liberia was admitted to the African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities and Smart Africa, and agreed with Morocco to pursue a cybersecurity memorandum.

The traffic is not all inbound. Sierra Leone's procurement authority sent a delegation to Liberia's PPCC for a two-day study tour of the e-GP system on 6-7 August 2026. Liberia is one of three countries, with Benin and Sierra Leone, in the World Bank's $137m WARDIP2 operation approved on 11 March 2026, and signed its own $50m tranche on 8 June 2026. Economic integration remains the weak measure: 31.0 out of 100.0, 41st of 54 in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, up 5.0 points over the decade (2023). The central bank governor led a delegation to the Bank of Ghana on 1 October 2026 to study how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement company, under a memorandum the two central banks signed earlier in the year.

### Standards

Liberia has no coordinated national spatial data infrastructure: geospatial information is collected institution by institution and mapping remains fragmented, so data gathered by one government body is not systematically shared with others. The Liberia Land Authority took that case to the 16th session of UN-GGIM, the UN Committee of Experts on Global Geospatial Information Management, in August 2026, seeking international partnerships and technical support to build one.

Where standards do exist they are sectoral and set by the Central Bank. Mobile money, the instant payment system and the planned national switch all sit on the Central Bank's Mobile Money Regulations, and that general framework is published; the participation, pricing and technical rules of the instant payment system itself are not, sitting instead in agreements between the bank, the switch operator and the mobile money operators.

Open source has entered the government estate through a procurement choice rather than a policy: the instant payment system runs on the open-source Mojaloop platform. Procurement is the one lever now carrying statutory force, since the 2026 Public Procurement and Concessions Act requires entities to use the e-GP system, and paper licensing is being retired alongside it by the Telecommunications Authority's automated licensing and renewal platform, launched in August 2026 with the in-person route kept open.

The Liberia Standards Authority became a correspondent member of ISO in October 2025, its dues paid through an EU-funded project.

The one harmonised technical specification on the horizon is regional: WURI commits ECOWAS member states, Liberia among them, to common specifications for foundational digital identity, a programme commitment rather than a published standard.

### Public debate and participation in policymaking

The Press Union of Liberia has publicly challenged the Civil Service Agency's newly introduced staff confidentiality and non-disclosure agreement, warning on 5 August 2026 that it must be aligned with the Freedom of Information Act and that the agency "must not be seen as an entity that is reintroducing secrecy in government."

That the challenge is made in the open is characteristic. Participation is one of Liberia's two top-ten governance sub-categories in the 2024 Ibrahim Index at 65.1 out of 100.0, 8th of 54 African states, with Civil Society Space at 90.7, 2nd of 54 and up 6.0 points over the decade, and Deliberative & Participatory Governance at 75.9, 4th of 54 though down 3.0 (2023). The expression measures run the other way: Media Freedom scores 66.0, 11th of 54, down 2.0 points, and Freedom of Expression & Belief 70.0, 21st, down 8.2, while Liberians' own assessment of freedom of speech stands at 68.6, 15th of 54, down 11.3 points over 2014-2023 (2023).

The one channel running inward is the SMS shortcode 2424, relaunched by the President in April 2026 for citizens to report on named officials and stalled projects under the 2026 performance contracts, after a first run in 2023 as a feedback line on public-service delivery; no count of messages is published. Otherwise government's digital communication is outward: the Civil Service Agency's website, virtual information assistant, magazine and new monthly newsletter, launched on 5 August 2026, carry information out to civil servants and the public, and digital government activity is disclosed through periodic strategy publications and press briefings, and the performance management information system launched in April 2026 promises quarterly results for every institution on one public platform, with no systematic reporting on data-sharing agreements or data exchange governance.

Particular decisions stay closed. The national ID steering committee's report to President Boakai has not been made public, and neither Liberia nor Sierra Leone publishes award, tender, bidder or contract-value data from the e-GP system. Access to public records has improved markedly from a low base but remains below the halfway mark: Disclosure of Public Records at 44.1, 13th of 54, and Accessibility of Public Records at 41.3, 16th of 54 (2023).

The argument is nonetheless being had where it can be seen. A Liberian Observer editorial has argued that the country cannot build digital sovereignty by outsourcing its digital infrastructure, warning that partnership in the national ID concession must not become dependency.

## Finance

### Financial sustainability

Liberia is to carry the next phase of its identity system off the budget: OeSD International is to finance about US$54.7 million of enrolment and infrastructure under a build-operate-transfer concession that is signed but cannot be implemented until the Legislature ratifies it (September 2026), and the company is to recover its investment over time before transferring the system to government, with the registry disclosing the agreement's details only after legislative approval (August 2026).

The treasury's own digital lines grew in the 2026 budget: it more than doubles the identity registry's appropriation to US$2.0 million, US$1 million of it the registry's first funded investment project since 2024, raises the national postal addressing system to US$1.1 million, and opens new lines of US$1.2 million for the national cadastre, US$355,000 for digitising court records and a US$400,000 transfer for the security and data protection act (FY2026), against US$0.8 million for the registry and US$250,000 for addressing in 2025 (FY2025). The IFMIS licence fees, US$165,850, sit on the state's own budget (FY2026).

The digital lines of the 2026 national budget come to US$7.1 million appropriated, up from US$5.1 million in 2025 and against US$8.3 million in 2024 (FY2026). Just over half of the 2024 appropriation was spent (FY2024).

The budget's chapters carry Government of Liberia money only, and its external-resources annex lists aid by partner, sector and modality with no project lines, so no externally financed digital line is printed (FY2026). Of the US$2.76 million voted in 2024 for the revenue authority's project digitising revenue transactions across government, US$421,401 was spent (FY2024). The World Bank's GREAT digital-government project closes on 30 November 2030, and its appraisal commits research into financing options for the county one-stop service centres, including private operation.

What the state has in law is a levy on telecoms licensees: the Universal Access Fund takes 0.5% of designated licensees' annual gross revenue, and its budget is approved each year by the Legislature within the national budget (2015). The telecoms regulator's chairman declined in July 2026 to disclose publicly what the authority collects in licence fees, spectrum charges and levies.

### MoUs and other agreements

The health memorandum of understanding Liberia signed with the United States on 9 December 2025 plans US$124,418,400 of American support against US$50,725,704 from Liberia, while stating that it "is not an international agreement and does not give rise to legal rights and obligations". Health data systems are one of the lines it plans, running to 2030; it is money intended rather than money moved.

Of the eleven external commitments touching Liberia's digital estate, only one rests on a memorandum of understanding rather than a grant, a loan or a guarantee — and it is the fourth-largest of them by value.

Neither government has put the text out itself: the memorandum is public as a copy posted by a third party, as is the America First Global Health Strategy template it follows, published by Public Citizen. Elsewhere the signing is lighter: the National Port Authority has an agreement with the French port operator HAROPA to digitise state port operations (July 2026), with no sum, scope of works or delivery date announced.

The one arrangement with a named technology vendor that will carry obligations is the national identification concession with Austria's OSD. The US$54.7 million build-operate-transfer agreement is signed and before the Legislature, whose ratification the National Identification Registry urged on 16 September 2026 — so it is not yet in force, and its terms are not published. Public-private structure is the stated mechanism rather than a fallback: the arrangement was restructured into a public-private partnership concession under which OSD finances enrolment, operates the system and then transfers it to the state (May 2026), and President Boakai rejected a traditional procurement model in favour of that concession (August 2026). The same pattern reaches the informal economy: Digital Liberia and the merged motorcycle and tricycle riders' union signed a memorandum in August 2026 to build digital identification, a rider and vehicle database and GPS tracking for commercial riders.

### New investments

Liberia signed its US$50 million tranche of the regional WARDIP2 digital programme on 8 June 2026, part of a US$125 million World Bank package covering energy, digital and infrastructure. The other flagship is the GREAT project, launched in March 2025 with US$30 million of World Bank funding, the country's digital public infrastructure programme, financing the national identification enrolment push. Commitment is not the constraint; disbursement is. Part of the World Bank funding for the identification programme was placed on hold as the national ID rollout stalled (March 2026).

Eleven digital-sector commitments touch Liberia as at September 2026, running from 2015 to 2031, seven of them still live. The recorded value passes US$200 million (September 2026), though much of that is guarantee cover rather than money into the country, and one, a Korean youth digital-capacity grant, carries no US-dollar figure. Five are grants, three are World Bank concessional loans and two are MIGA guarantees; the eleventh, and the fourth-largest by value, is the United States health data-systems plan, which carries no instrument type and is expressly non-binding. MIGA is the largest financier by recorded value and the World Bank second; USAID holds three commitments, and the African Development Bank, the U.S. Department of State and Korea's foreign ministry one each. Connectivity carries the largest committed value, ahead of management information systems, registries and digital identity.

The largest single live commitment is MIGA's political-risk guarantee over Orange Liberia, issued on 8 September 2023 for up to eight years, backing tower construction, fibre installation and mobile financial services — cover for equity already there, not new money in. A second MIGA guarantee covers solar-hybrid power at about 612 tower sites. The African Development Bank is the other active financier, with a grant upgrading the Central Bank of Liberia's payment systems and data centres and another, through the West African Monetary Institute, on unique bank identification with Sierra Leone, The Gambia and Guinea. United States money is historic: the health systems, connectivity and digital investment activities have all closed. ECOWAS funds none of it from its own resources, and no funding figure has been disclosed for UNDP's digital-transformation workstreams (July 2026).

## ICT Infrastructure

### Connectivity

The Liberia Telecommunications Authority signed comprehensive Satellite Communications Guidelines on 19 August 2026, opening licensed satellite broadband to Starlink, Eutelsat OneWeb and Amazon Kuiper. They price direct-to-device service separately from ordinary satellite broadband, setting a US$250,000 D2D service-provider licence fee alongside a 9 per cent levy on D2D sales and a 0.5 per cent universal-access contribution, and grant five-year landing rights to non-geostationary operators and ten-year rights to geostationary ones, with a twelve-month transition for existing licensees.

Use is the thin part. Internet use stood at 23.5 per cent of the population in 2023; the 2024 IIAG scores Internet & Computers at 21.4 out of 100.0 and 44th of 54 African states, mobile communications at 58.4 and 40th. 4G reached most of the population in 2023, but no unique-subscriber penetration figure is published for Liberia, and the rate usually quoted counts SIM connections rather than people; an entry-level mobile broadband basket falls within the moderate affordability band. Liberians' own rating of their infrastructure fell 4.6 points over 2014-2023, to 39.7 out of 100.0, even as the measured score rose, to 26.9.

International capacity rests on a single submarine cable, the ACE system, backed since May 2025 by a mobile operator's fibre link to Côte d'Ivoire that reaches six other undersea cables and carried all of Liberia's international traffic through a four-day ACE outage, and an open-access carrier's 350 km backbone runs from Monrovia to the Côte d'Ivoire and Guinea borders (2024). The shared regional answer is still an agreement rather than a service: Liberia, Sierra Leone, Guinea and Côte d'Ivoire agreed at Abidjan in June 2026 to commercialise the spare fibre strung on the TRANSCO CLSG power transmission line, targeting operation before the end of 2026. A second submarine route is also in prospect but not built: ECOWAS member-state experts with their technical and financial partners approved the feasibility study for a second cable serving Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea-Bissau at a Monrovia workshop in October 2025, with no route, cost, landing site or construction date published since. Traffic that could stay in country often does not: the one operational internet exchange point, in Monrovia, has limited participation, with incomplete peering among ISPs and mobile operators raised at a 2025 national peering forum.

The regulator announced a sweeping package of telecom reforms in July 2026 and revoked Star Cell's operating licence after six years of inactivity, and moved applications and renewals online in August 2026. Funding is external: Liberia signed its tranche of the regional WARDIP2 digital programme on 8 June 2026, and the largest single live commitment to the digital estate is MIGA's US$81 million political-risk guarantee over Orange Liberia, issued in September 2023 for up to eight years.

### Data Storage

The Liberia Telecommunications Authority's cybersecurity regulations of January 2026 require every telecommunications service provider to store personal data primarily inside Liberia, a second sectoral hosting rule beside the Central Bank's, under which electronic payment systems must be hosted locally or, if hosted abroad, give it unfettered access to system data and reports; there is no economy-wide localisation law.

Liberia's hosting capacity is confined to a small number of facilities, chiefly the National Data Center operated by the state operator LTC-Mobile, which is being upgraded under the World Bank-financed GREAT project. There is nothing nearby to fall back on: no hyperscale or regional cloud availability zone exists in or near the country, the nearest AWS region being Cape Town, and neither Google Cloud nor Microsoft Azure operates a West African region, so cloud services reach Liberia from far away.

Government's own store is the identity system rather than a shared platform, and it is a central data centre to which enrolment centres in all 15 counties send encrypted records over a network link or, when offline, on portable storage media (2024). Who controls it has not been settled: the Nairobi firm that built it withheld full database access from the National Identification Registry over an unpaid balance the approved 2026 budget made no provision for. The Central Bank's main and recovery site data centres are being upgraded to industry standard under an African Development Bank grant running to 2026, and it invited international bids for the upgrade on 28 September 2026.

### Energy

Supply falls short every dry season, from December to April, and the utility covers the gap with imports; when Côte d'Ivoire cut its deliveries from 50 MW to 7.5 MW in February 2025, load shedding widened across Monrovia while low water held back the Mount Coffee hydropower plant. That is the supply behind every screen and server in the country.

Electricity access doubled over the decade to 2024, to about a third of the population, and it is overwhelmingly urban: 52.7 per cent of the urban population had access in 2023 against 9.3 per cent of the rural population, a gap of roughly 43 percentage points. Access to Energy is among Liberia's ten worst-scoring measures in the 2024 IIAG, at 13.8 out of 100.0 and 46th of 54 African states, though it recorded the largest ten-year gain within the Infrastructure sub-category, up 10.9 points over 2014-2023. What there is costs about US$0.24 per kilowatt-hour (2024), a level the World Bank treats as high.

Renewable plant, led by the 88 MW Mount Coffee hydropower station, made up about 70 per cent of the 126 MW of installed generating capacity in 2024. Off-grid supply is provided for rather than left to chance: an active off-grid policy is partly deployed, with solar mini-grids for rural communities and results-based financing for solar home systems. Where the grid does not reach, the network carries its own power — a MIGA political-risk guarantee of US$12.06 million, running up to ten years from 2020, covers Escotel's installation and operation of solar-hybrid systems at about 612 telecom tower sites owned or operated by Orange Liberia.

### Technical Capacity

Liberia's working developer base is too small for the platforms to measure: GitHub's Innovation Graph publishes no developer count for the country because it falls below the platform's hundred-developer quarterly reporting threshold, leaving a small community sustained by Google Developer Group Monrovia, Innovations Hub bootcamps and university IT programmes. The pipeline behind it is narrow too: ICT degree programmes are offered by only a couple of the country's universities.

The administration scores better than the sector it is trying to build. Effective Administration stands at 50.6 out of 100.0 in the 2024 IIAG, 28th of 54 African states and up 4.7 points over 2014-2023, and Public Administration is the sub-category driving most of Liberia's overall governance improvement, rising 10.1 points over the same decade to 46.3, though the country still ranks only 36th.

Readiness to run what government commissions is being assembled a box at a time. The Public Procurement and Concessions Commission began distributing computers and printers in August 2026 to the first batch of ministries, agencies and commissions joining the second phase of the e-procurement platform, a phase meant to reach far more institutions than the six covered in the first; the telecoms regulator has separately received equipment to strengthen its own use of that platform. Some capacity has been moved rather than bought: the National Elections Commission transferred its biometric voter registration kits to the National Identification Registry in July 2025 to avoid duplicated procurement, and a steering committee chaired by the National Security Advisor was appointed the same

month to oversee the restart of the biometric ID rollout. Money is the constraint: the identity registry runs on chronic shortfalls, an outstanding debt to its technology provider and World Bank disbursements blocked by government debt.

### Cybersecurity

The law Liberia's digital defences rest on can now be read: the printed Cybercrime Act of 2025 creates a National Cybersecurity Council with the financial intelligence agency seated and the national CERT as its technical arm, requires breach reports to the CERT within 72 hours and protects whistleblowers.

There is no adopted strategy behind it. The Ministry of Posts and Telecommunications' National Cybersecurity Strategy carries a July 2024 cover date for a 2025-2029 period while its own running headers read "Draft National Cybersecurity Strategy 2024-2029", and no adoption instrument accompanies it. It nonetheless sets a dated legislative programme running from Q3 2025 to Q1 2026 and commits the country to acceding to the Budapest and Malabo Conventions, to neither of which it is a party. Measured readiness matches: Liberia sits in the lowest "building" tier of the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index (2024).

Critical infrastructure was provided for in the 2021 draft text, which allowed computer systems and networks to be designated Critical National Information Infrastructure and audited and inspected once designated, and opens its offence schedule on attacks against that infrastructure and on unlawful access to computer systems. That draft carried no duty to report breaches to the national computer emergency response team and no whistleblower protection; the enacted Act carries both.

The estate has not been reviewed to match. No pre-implementation risk assessment or privacy impact assessment was documented for the biometric ID system, the NIR Act requires none, and access rules are drawn broadly enough to name security personnel, civil servants, public agents and private individuals without clear protocols. The Central Bank publishes a signed external audit of its 2024 accounts but nothing scoped to the instant payment system's own security or operations. In February 2026 the House of Representatives opened a probe into an alleged breach of personal data held by the revenue authority, the electricity corporation and the identity registry.

## DPI

### Data Exchange

Liberia has no operational government data exchange platform: e-government systems remain fragmented and mutually incompatible, and the identity registry's bilateral memoranda stand in place of any cross-government layer (2025). The links that do carry traffic are one-to-one. The Liberia Integrated Tax Administration System verifies taxpayers' national identification numbers against the registry in real time, an integration the Revenue Authority reported operational alongside a real-time payment link with a single commercial bank (2024). The registry also holds interfaces and memoranda with the Ministry of Health, the passport and driver-licence authorities, the pension body NASSCORP, the Civil Service Agency and the telecoms regulator, but the older functional programmes were never built to interoperate, so what exists is bilateral rather than systemic (2025).

No law requires or governs cross-government data sharing. The legal basis for digital services is the Electronic Transactions Law of 2002, the registry's 2011 Act, the 2019-2024 ICT policy and the Central Bank's 2020 e-payment regulations. The five-year Digital Liberia strategy for 2025-2029 puts data sovereignty and interoperability among its themes but carries no data exchange strategy and no roadmap with milestones (2026). Geospatial information is collected institution by institution with no coordinated national spatial data infrastructure (August 2026), and the statistics institute's own survey of data users recommended a formal inter-agency protocol and application programming interfaces because cross-agency flows still depend on manual working groups (2026).

Neither the workings nor the data-sovereignty terms are public. Government discloses its digital and data-exchange activity through periodic strategy publications and press briefings, with no dashboard and no systematic reporting on data-sharing agreements (2026). The data-sharing agreement attached to Liberia's December 2025 health memorandum with the United States is being pursued through freedom-of-information litigation in Washington rather than read on a government website (April 2026), and the nearest text on the public record is a model agreement released by an American advocacy group rather than by the State Department.

### Digital Identity and CRVS

Liberia's national identity registry has been shut for most of a year: issuance was suspended in August 2025, and the registry closed entirely in early 2026 after the procurement commission rejected a restricted-bid award to a foreign firm. The Nairobi company that built the system for US$5.9 million then withheld full database access over a US$1.7 million unpaid balance, leaving roughly 640,000 people already registered unable to obtain their cards (March 2026). Coverage stands below 15 per cent of a population of more than five million (August 2026).

The registry runs the National Biometric Identification System under its 2011 Act, issuing a unique number and a biometric card to citizens and residents, with enrolment open from birth. About 740,000 people had been enrolled by December 2024, roughly 14 per cent of the population. Executive Order No. 147 of 14 April 2025 made enrolment compulsory for citizens and for foreign nationals resident 90 days or more; no statute stands behind it. A card costs a citizen US$5 and a foreign resident US$10 or US$20, a fee lawmakers pressed to abolish in 2025.

The Act releases registry data only to the applicant or on court order, but no specialised tribunal or judicial oversight of the system exists, and no privacy or risk assessment was documented before implementation while access rules name public agents and private individuals without clear protocols (2025). The card is nonetheless the primary credential for public and private services, required for banking, health, education and telecommunications and mandatory for SIM registration; banks have required it to open or reactivate an account since June 2025, and applicants caught in the backlog were refused service. Verification runs on the registry's own platform, by card or fingerprint, with batch checks for authorised institutions (2024).

Civil registration underneath is only partly digital and not joined to the register it should feed: completeness was about 66 per cent (2020), registration had been decentralised to 58 centres in all 15 counties by December 2024, and no operating link between civil registration and the population register exists (2024). Government has since chosen a concession over an outright purchase; the agreement with the Austrian State Printing House is signed and went to the Legislature, whose ratification the registry urged on 16 September 2026, and in October 2026 the House referred it to a joint committee with 14 days to report. The card is ECOWAS-compliant in design, but Liberia has not implemented the ECOWAS biometric identity card, so cross-border recognition remains partial (2025).

### Digital Payments and Fintech

Liberia's mobile money silos ended on 16 December 2025, when the Central Bank launched Pay Na-Na, a national real-time interoperable payment system built on the open-source Mojaloop platform, carrying person-to-person and government-to-person transfers between the Lonestar MTN and Orange wallets that had operated as separate silos. It was built in 73 business days. Under the approved fee regime a transfer carries no more than 1.0 per cent of value between US$1 and US$2,000, and a flat fee of no more than US$25 above that (August 2026). The central bank governor put the system at more than 5.3 million interoperable transactions since launch, about 4.2 million in Liberian dollars and 1.1 million in US dollars (October 2026).

That schedule turns regressive above its US$2,000 break: the US$25 cap equals 1.25 per cent of a US$2,000 transfer, so the charge rises at the threshold and then falls as a share of value on every larger transfer, becoming cheaper in percentage terms than the 1.0 per cent band from roughly US$2,500 upward.

Government was the first user rather than the last. A directive of September 2025 requires mobile-money government-to-person payments and government revenue collections to be routed through the national switch, and civil-servant salaries moved off cheques into mobile wallets at launch; most civil servants in the counties covered by the first phase are now paid that way (2026). Collections have moved more slowly: taxpayers can pay taxes and fees for 18 ministries and agencies from a phone through a separate Revenue Authority platform, while on the switch the person-to-government leg and the National Electronic Payment Switch itself are still to follow (July 2026); the finance minister targeted the switch for March 2027 (September 2026).

Operators sit under the Central Bank's Mobile Money Regulations, and the 2020 electronic payment services regulations carry consumer and data protection sections and require a complaints desk with recourse to the Bank's Customer Protection Unit. Conduct rules sit beside them: the consumer protection and market conduct regulations gazetted in January 2020 bind institutions to customer-data confidentiality and complaint handling, and digital credit guidelines of March 2022 cap a digital loan at US$400 and extend those rules to mobile-money lenders. The scheme's own participation, pricing and technical rules, though, are not published, and the Bank runs the system as well as regulating it, holding the settlement accounts and moving funds on the operator's instructions.

Reach and reporting are the weak points. Account ownership stood at 52 per cent of adults (2024); the National Financial Inclusion Strategy expired with its 2026-2030 successor still in drafting, and an assessment of it found consumer protection among the weakest areas (2026). Payment data is reported annually by the Central Bank, which counted 11.5 million registered and 4.3 million active mobile money subscribers in 2024, and no audit scoped to the payment system's security, operations or compliance is published (2024).

### Registries

The Central Bank launched an enhanced collateral registry on 27 August 2026 under a regulation gazetted on 6 July 2026 that extends it to immovable property, in a country with no operational digital land register: the Land Authority is still digitising Monrovia's hand-drawn cadastral maps and signed a memorandum with South Korean partners in October 2025 to build a land information system. Until then the registry had covered movable assets only — vehicles, inventory, household items — since 2010. Formal tenure beneath it is rare: 13.8 per cent of agricultural landholdings have official documentation, from 44.9 per cent in Montserrado County to 6.6 per cent in the south-east (2024). Addressing runs separately again, through a National Digital and Postal Addressing System with an online registration portal, deployed in part rather than nationally (2024).

The economic registers are the most advanced and the least connected. Liberia has launched a digital beneficial ownership register, publishing company ownership online (2023), and business registration itself has moved to an online platform — but the Business Registry is not interfaced with the Revenue Authority's tax system or any other government platform, so a business that must register before registering for tax passes no data automatically between the two (2025).

The electoral and social registers duplicate the identity system rather than draw on it. Liberia ran biometric voter registration nationwide for the October 2023 elections, producing a roll of 2,471,617 voters, but the Elections Commission and the identity registry keep separate databases (2025), though the two formed a technical working committee after the registry's May 2024 enrolment roadmap, and the Commission handed over more than 500 biometric registration kits in July 2025. The Household Social Registry, the national targeting tool, has enrolled over 250,000 households and serves three social protection programmes (2025) — and issues its own scannable household ID cards, with a unique household identifier drawing on biometrics, national identity cards or voter cards listed as work still to come (2023). None of them reaches an exchange layer, because there is none to reach.

### Sectoral management information systems

Line ministries run their own sector systems: the Ministry of Labour launched LiberiaWorks in October 2025 to link employers, jobseekers, universities and government. The justice sector's case management system has run at the National Police since 2021 and was launched at the Judiciary by June 2022, with one harmonised system for the whole justice chain stated as the goal, while the only police station serving rural Todee District has no computers (January 2026). Agriculture is procuring a mechanisation tracking system meant to link to the National Farmer Registry, subject to an assessment of that registry's readiness (2026).

Health data is the most heavily funded and the least complete. USAID's health systems programme built the national health management information system and the iHRIS human-resources register, and closed in 2022. A DHIS2 tracker for client-level HIV data replaced paper registers at 21 PEPFAR-supported treatment sites from 2021, but facility electronic records remain partner deployments such as OpenMRS at J.J. Dossen Hospital in Maryland County, live since July 2020, and in May 2026 the Ministry launched a nationwide assessment of readiness for electronic medical records — an exercise premising that routine digital capture is not yet the norm. A December 2025 memorandum with the United States intends further funding for medical records, laboratory systems and the national health data warehouse over 2026-2030.

The gender ministry launched an upgraded gender-based violence information system for incident reporting, survivor case management and referrals in October 2026, and a community health information system to replace largely paper-based community reporting was put out to tender in January 2026, after an OpenSRP2 application for community health workers was piloted in four counties from September 2023. A DHIS2-based immunisation registry was piloted at 19 facilities in three counties from December 2023, with national rollout described as planned, and the ministry reported training on it in all fifteen counties, and a contract for integrating the workforce register with DHIS2, by August 2025.

Education is mid-transition: the Ministry has moved from paper to a digital EMIS 2.0 and validated a costed plan in September 2025 introducing national unique learner and teacher identifiers, against no school data collected between the 2022 census and the September 2025 review. The Revenue Authority operates its integrated tax administration system nationwide, built out with customs and IFMIS under a US$24 million World Bank project that closed in 2024. Two systems reach for the national identifier: the Civil Service Agency signed a memorandum in May 2024 to verify government payroll against national identification numbers and detect ghost workers, and the pension body NASSCORP is among the systems the registry lists with a data-sharing interface (2024). A facility survey found all 48 sampled facilities in three counties reporting on paper forms keyed by district or county clerks (2023). A private offline-first electronic health record and disease-surveillance platform went into live clinical use on 1 September 2026 and reached seven clinics and health centres in about three weeks, with the national public health institute as its surveillance partner.

### Other GovTech and e-Gov

Electronic procurement is the one part of Liberia's digital government running at national scale, and it publishes nothing about what it buys. The e-GP system began as a six-institution pilot and went national in February 2025 with World Bank and African Development Bank backing; the 2026 Public Procurement and Concessions Act now requires procuring entities to use it, and a second phase is extending it, with equipment going out to the Ministry of State for Presidential Affairs, the Civil Service Agency, the Water and Sewer Corporation and the ministries of Labour and of Mines and Energy (August 2026). Yet neither country publishes award, tender, bidder or contract-value data from the system, so its standing as the region's most advanced platform is a claim about deployment, not transparency.

There is no working single national service portal on record: an eLiberia one-stop portal was launched in July 2018, and nothing later is held on it. What a citizen or a business can do online is done agency by agency: taxpayer registration, e-filing and online payment of taxes and customs duties at the Revenue Authority, company registration at the Business Registry, address registration at Posts and Telecommunications, and since August 2026 telecom licence application and renewal at the telecoms regulator, with the paper route kept open alongside. The public financial management core beneath them, IFMIS, was last rebuilt under the World Bank project that closed in 2024.

Coordination arrived only this year. Executive Order 163, signed in April 2026, created a digital-government framework around an Office for Technology and Digital Innovation and a National Digital Master Infrastructure, and gives twelve months for a law institutionalising it to be drafted — so this framework too rests on an order rather than a statute. The World Bank's GREAT project is building digital-government systems across nine institutions to November 2030, and a regional operation approved in March 2026 finances broadband and digital public services across Liberia, Benin and Sierra Leone. Measured readiness stays low, at 0.2905 on the UN E-Government Development Index (2024), and behind the front ends the systems still run as separate ministries rather than as one government. The deputy information minister said the online police clearance platform had generated more than US$200,000 since its introduction in May 2026.

## Digitalisation

### Digitalisation of sub-national government

Liberia's counties appear in the national digital systems as places data is gathered from, not as administrations running systems of their own. Civil registration is the strongest case for the county tier, decentralised across every county and recorded on the DHIS2 platform. The school monitoring system piloted in county schools from March 2026 is a ministry instrument operating in the counties rather than a county one, as is the online case management system built for the justice institutions with UNDP support. The state's local premises show what sits beneath that: a police station in Lower Montserrado with no computers in January 2026. Rural voice in national policy improved sharply over the decade to 2023, placing Liberia among the most improved African states on rural representation and participation, but that is a gain in how rural interests are heard nationally rather than in what county government can do.

### Rural digital data capture

Rural Economy was Liberia's fastest-improving governance sub-category of the decade to 2023, up 30.9 points to 71.1 out of 100 and eleventh of 54 African states, and Rural Representation & Participation rose 31.7 points to 65.6, the sixth most improved of the index's 96 indicators. The gain is uneven: Rural Economy Support reaches 76.9, tenth of 54, while Rural Land & Water Access sits at 47.5, thirty-third, despite rising 16.3 points.

Very little of rural life is recorded digitally where it happens. Birth registration is the exception: it had been decentralised to 58 centres in all fifteen counties by December 2024, recorded on a birth registration information system built on the DHIS2 platform. Schools lag, though the Ministry of Education's geo-mapping monitoring system, launched in March 2026, has school staff enter geo-referenced data on site and was piloted to June 2026 across five counties including rural Rivercess and Gbarpolu, while the education management information system's move off paper remains unfinished.

Health and policing still run on paper. The Ministry of Health launched a nationwide assessment of facility readiness for electronic medical records in May 2026; electronic records exist as scattered deployments such as OpenMRS at J.J. Dossen Hospital in rural Maryland County, and facilities otherwise report on paper forms keyed by district or

county clerks (2023). Police case files remain physical: a January 2026 account of Nyehn Town Police Station in Lower Montserrado describes a building with no computers where officers work to keep files out of the rain, years after officers elsewhere began recording GPS-tagged crime reports on tablets.

Rural electricity access was a small fraction of the urban rate in 2023, met partly by off-grid solar, and the agriculture ministry's planned machinery tracking system will link to the National Farmer Registry only if an assessment finds the registry ready (2026). The land record is largely informal, with only a small minority of agricultural holdings documented in 2024, no agricultural census in twenty years and agriculture the weakest Liberian data category scored in 2024. The identity registry has named Salayea in Lofa County as its first new enrolment office, in August 2026.

## Technology

### AI

The only artificial intelligence in service in Liberian government is an information chatbot: the Civil Service Agency runs an AI-powered virtual information assistant alongside its website, staff magazine and new monthly newsletter, built out since 2024 (August 2026). It answers questions about the agency rather than carrying a transaction.

The nearest thing to a stated national position sits inside the Ministry of Posts and Telecommunications' draft National Data Governance Policy, which recommends that machine learning be built into the government's digital roadmap with safeguards for automated decision-making. That draft remains unenacted (2026), so the safeguards bind nobody, and the data classification rules such systems would have to draw on are not in force either.

What movement there is comes from outside. UNDP names AI for government among its three digital workstreams in Liberia and counts AI and cybersecurity teaching at the University of Liberia among its contributions (July 2026) — a workstream named and a course taught, neither of which is a system running.

### ICT Industry

Where the Liberian state buys digital capability, it buys it abroad. The National Port Authority's smart-ports memorandum with the French port operator HAROPA would digitise state port operations under a foreign operator (July 2026), and it is a memorandum rather than a signed scope of works.

There is little domestic supply it could have bought from instead. The working developer base sits below the threshold at which the platforms report a country at all (2025), venture capital does not reach Liberian technology firms (2025), and what stands in place of a firm base is a small set of hubs and incubators that train and convene rather than employ in numbers.

### Innovation ecosystem

Liberia is absent from the comparison most innovation policy is argued from: it is one of 117 economies left out of the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024 for want of sufficient data coverage, against 133 ranked. That is not a low score. It is no score, and it means the country cannot be placed against its neighbours on any of the index's pillars.

What exists is hub-shaped rather than firm-shaped. iLab Liberia and its iCampus, the DKS Incubation Center and Innovations Hub Liberia run training, incubation and civic-technology programmes, and they are the practical entry point for anyone starting a technology business in the country.

Financing is the side that is missing. Partech's 2025 Africa technology venture capital report records no funded venture deals in Liberia, in a year the continent's funding rebounded, which leaves the hubs supplying mentorship and space in place of capital that does not arrive.

## Capacity

### Literacy

Liberian schooling is getting better at holding on to the children who reach it and worse at getting them there in the first place. Education Enrolment fell 7.6 points over the decade to 41.6 out of 100.0, twenty-second of fifty-four African states (2023), while over the same ten years Education Completion rose 17.7 points to 21.8, thirty-seventh of fifty-four, and Equality in Education rose 17.1 points to 52.1, twenty-fifth (2023). The composite Education score of 43.3 out of 100.0, up 4.7 points and thirty-ninth on the continent, is the average of those opposing movements, and completion at 21.8 remains one of the lowest figures anywhere in the country's governance profile. A cohort that finishes school in far greater numbers than a decade ago is being drawn from a shrinking share of the school-age population.

What the schools have, in staff terms, is not the constraint. Human Resources in Education scores 78.1 out of 100.0, thirtieth of fifty-four and up 4.9 points over the decade, placing it among Liberia's ten best-scoring measures, with Education Quality at 44.0, twenty-eighth, up 9.1 points (2023). Quality and teaching capacity have both risen faster than the system's ability to enrol.

The machinery that would let anyone check this is only now being digitised. Liberia's education management information system is still moving from paper to a digital successor, with no school data collected between the 2022 census and the September 2025 review, and the ministry's costed plan for unique learner and teacher identifiers was validated in September 2025 against a multi-year gap since the last school census. Externally, education outcomes are among the categories for which the 2024 Open Data Inventory found no Liberian data meeting its coverage and openness criteria. A citizen, or a ministry, wanting to know how a given county's schools are performing cannot look it up.

### Training and skills

The most regular public digital training on offer in Liberia is a procurement helpdesk: the Public Procurement and Concessions Commission runs an e-GP Clinic twice a week to teach vendors to use the government procurement platform (August 2026). It is narrow by design — one system, one audience — but it is recurring, state-run and aimed squarely at the people who have to transact with government digitally.

Beyond it, the training that exists is donor-carried. UNDP's digital work runs through an innovation hub and AI and cybersecurity programmes at the University of Liberia, alongside a digital-skills partnership with Orange Liberia (July 2026), and the country's technology hubs — iLab Liberia and its iCampus, the DKS Incubation Center, Innovations Hub Liberia — run training and civic-tech programmes reaching across the counties. None of it adds up to a national digital skills programme.

The academic pipeline behind it is thin to the point of near-absence: ICT degree provision barely exists across the Liberian university system (2025). The community that results is correspondingly small — Liberia sits below the reporting threshold at which GitHub publishes a developer count for a country (2025) — and is sustained by bootcamps and developer groups rather than by degree programmes.

On the demand side, the state has built the matching layer before the supply exists. The Ministry of Labour's LiberiaWorks workforce platform links employers, jobseekers and universities through a talent marketplace and a placement programme, but stands unconnected to digital ID or any other government registry, so it cannot yet verify the people it lists.

### Research institutions

Liberia's universities are not yet a base from which technology research could be produced: ICT degree provision barely exists across the university system (2025), and the research-adjacent capacity that does exist sits in donor programmes — UNDP's innovation hub and its AI and cybersecurity work at the University of Liberia (July 2026) — rather than in departments with their own funding.

The evidence base such research would draw on is the system's weakest part. Liberia's statistical system capacity is among the lowest scored on the continent and has not improved over the decade (2023), and the World Bank's statistical performance measures put data sources — censuses, surveys, administrative and geospatial data — as the weakest of the five pillars, well below data use (2023). Knowledge is being used here faster than it is being generated.

## Inclusion

### Access to services

Equal Access to Public Services is among Liberia's ten worst-scoring measures in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, at 15.0 out of 100.0 and 49th of 54 African states, and a decade of reform moved it 0.3 points (2023).

What now stands between a Liberian and a service is a card. Executive Order 147 makes the national identification number a requirement for banking, health, education and telecommunications; banks have demanded it to open or reactivate an account since June 2025; and the register itself covers a small minority of the population (August 2026). Hundreds of thousands who had already registered could not collect their cards while a vendor dispute ran (March 2026), and allegations of bribery at overwhelmed enrolment centres drew a legislative probe (June 2025).

The registry's own account of what limits it is a US$5 card fee and a ceiling of about 5,000 cards a day (2025). Lawmakers pressed through 2025 for the card to be issued free, and the registry's executive director, Andrew Peters, backs the proposal on condition that the government meets the cost (September 2025); officials say poor first-time applicants will not be charged under the planned concession (August 2026). Non-nationals sit inside the system rather than outside it, on a resident or foreigner card that carries the same service access (2025).

Where the state does reach people it does so increasingly through the registry and the wallet: social protection beneficiaries are being enrolled biometrically (2025), the household social registry targets the main programmes (2025), civil servants in three counties are being moved onto mobile money salaries (2026), and transfers between the two mobile money wallets became interoperable in December 2025. An entry-level mobile broadband bundle sat within the moderate affordability band (2022).

Outside Monrovia the counter is still mostly paper. The civil registry works through county registration centres and registration points attached to health facilities, and the identity registry's first new enrolment office has been named at Salayea in Lofa County ahead of the concession's ratification (August 2026).

### Digital divides

Equal Socioeconomic Opportunity is the second most deteriorated of the 96 indicators in Liberia's 2024 Ibrahim Index profile, down 23.0 points over 2014-2023 to 33.5 out of 100.0 and 40th of 54 African states (2023). Over the same decade that index put legal protection against discrimination and rural voice in national policy among the country's most improved measures, so what has widened is the material distance between Liberians rather than their standing in law or their place in the policy conversation.

The physical divide sits underneath that. Internet use reaches a minority of Liberians (2023), the electricity grid is concentrated in the towns with rural access a fraction of urban (2023), and Liberia's internet and computers score remains near the foot of the African ranking despite a decade of gains (2023). A rural household is therefore excluded twice over, from the power that runs a device and from the network that would connect it.

The scale of the gap between women's and men's internet use is not established, and Liberia is not surveyed individually in the GSMA's mobile gender gap reporting. The skills floor is on firmer ground: completion of schooling and equality in education both rose steeply over 2014-2023 from a very low base (2023), which is the one axis on which the decade's record is unambiguous.

## Data

### National statistics

Liberia's statistical system consumes data far better than it produces it. The World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators for 2023 put data use above 89 per cent while the data-sources pillar — censuses, surveys, administrative and geospatial data — sits in the 20-49 per cent band, the weakest of the five, with data products at 70-89 per cent and data services and data infrastructure each at 50-69 per cent. The capacity behind those sources has not moved in a decade: the 2024 Ibrahim Index scores the capacity of Liberia's statistical system at 32.7 out of 100 (2023), 45th of 54 African states and up 0.6 points over the ten years to that date, the weakest of its six public administration measures.

The collection gaps are specific. A population census and a business census had been run within the previous ten years, but no agricultural census within twenty (2023), and the survey programme of that decade ran to three or more health surveys, two household surveys, one labour force survey and one agricultural survey, with no business survey at all.

Administrative data does not yet fill the gap. The Liberia Institute of Statistics and Geo-Information Services compiles returns from ministries and agencies into national statistical bulletins, the most recent published in 2023, and its own 2025/2026 survey of data users and producers recommended a formal inter-agency data-sharing protocol and application programming interfaces because cross-agency flows still run through manual technical working groups (2026). Where registers have been digitised the coverage is partial: the education management information system is still moving off paper (2026), civil registration was split between the Ministry of Health and other agencies with no link between the systems (2019), and rural police stations keep case files and crime statistics on paper (January 2026). The 2025/2026 Annual School Census introduced greater school-based collection and digital validation.

The cost of the shortfall shows up outside Liberia's own reporting: the country was left out of the WIPO Global Innovation Index 2024 altogether, among the economies excluded for want of sufficient data coverage.

### Open data

Access to public records has improved sharply over the decade and still sits below halfway: the 2024 Ibrahim Index scores disclosure of public records at 44.1 out of 100 and accessibility at 41.3 (2023), 13th and 16th of 54 African states, up 11.9 and 10.1 points over the decade.

What is published is thin rather than closed. In the 2024 Open Data Inventory Liberia's social statistics score between 3.0 and 4.5 out of 10 for openness and its economic and financial statistics between 3.5 and 5.0, labour statistics highest and balance of payments lowest, while agriculture, at 2.5, is the weakest category scored at all, against 4.0 for the built environment. The same assessment returns no score for six further categories, among them energy, crime and justice, and education outcomes.

No data category in that assessment scores above 5.0 out of 10.

No open data policy governs any of this: the Ministry of Posts and Telecommunications' draft National Data Governance Policy remains unenacted (2026), geospatial information is collected institution by institution with no coordinated national spatial data infrastructure (August 2026), and digital government and data-exchange activity is disclosed only through periodic strategy publications and press briefings, with no public dashboard (2026). The systems that run publish little about themselves: the rules of the national instant payment system sit in agreements between the central bank, the switch operator and the mobile money operators rather than in a published rulebook (2025), and the electronic procurement platform releases no award, tender or contract-value data (August 2026). The digital beneficial ownership register under the Liberia Business Registry (2023) is the exception.

The right to ask rests on the Freedom of Information Act 2010, whose Independent Information Commission also takes the data-protection mandate rather than a new authority being created, under a data-protection Act in force since March 2026. That right does not reach far: the Cybercrime Act's speech-adjacent offences sit at sections 15 to 20, and the Press Union of Liberia has challenged a new Civil Service Agency staff confidentiality agreement as a reintroduction of secrecy in government (August 2026).

### Use of satellite data

Liberia now has a satellite ground receiving station: the Meteorological Service installed a CLIMSA/PUMA2025 Meteosat Third Generation system at Roberts International Airport on 24 October 2025, EU-funded and fitted under African Union Commission contract, receiving model data and high-resolution imagery. The observing network beneath it has not moved: the country's own contribution plan records no compliant surface stations, one operational staffed station and no transmission to the global system, with the earlier reception workstation underused for want of power and connectivity (2024).

Imagery is used most systematically in forestry rather than land administration. Liberia's second forest reference level, submitted to the UNFCCC in January 2026, reads a four-kilometre systematic sample of 5,990 plots from Sentinel-2, Landsat, MODIS and Planet imagery for 2020-2024, with cropland as an explicit class. Agriculture is catching up on two tracks: the agriculture regulator's traceability plan for cocoa, coffee, rubber and palm oil puts farm-level geolocation behind the EU deforestation regulation, with a 2020 forest-cover map and a 2000-2024 change analysis completed and at least US$530,000 committed (January 2026), and a nationwide soil mapping campaign began in Bong County in May 2026, ground-sampled, with national suitability, fertility and land-cover maps and a first digital soil information centre as its output.

In land administration the Land Authority is digitising Monrovia's hand-drawn cadastral maps and has signed for an integrated land information system (2025). No national space agency and no space or geospatial data policy had been established as at August 2026.

## Geopolitics

### US / hyperscaler activities

The terms on which the United States handles Liberian health data are now being fought over in an American court. Liberia is one of sixteen countries named in Public Citizen v. United States Department of State, filed in the District of Columbia on 2 April 2026, a freedom-of-information suit seeking the bilateral health framework or memorandum of understanding and its appendices — any data-sharing agreement, specimen agreement, financing agreements, budget tables and implementation plans. The State Department briefly published a subset of these memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access to them, and has released neither the remaining memoranda nor the agreements attached to them; it refused the requester's fee waiver on 30 December 2025 and, as at the filing on 2 April 2026, had made no final determination on the request and no ruling on the administrative appeal.

What can be read is the blank form. The model Data Sharing Agreement written for the America First Global Health Strategy and the template memorandum on which Liberia's 9 December 2025 agreement was built are public only as copies released by Public Citizen, with the country name left as an insertion point, and not as State Department publications. The department's own account of the programme is that these bilateral health-funding agreements typically pair a memorandum of understanding with at least one further agreement on data sharing. The Liberian memorandum that is public states that it is not an international agreement and does not give rise to legal rights and obligations, which is the footing on which American money for Liberian health data systems arrives.

Before that memorandum the American footprint ran through USAID, and it has been wound down: the health systems strengthening activity that built the national health management information system, the Connectivity for Liberia broadband and digital inclusion activity and the Digital Invest placement under the Digital Connectivity and Cybersecurity Partnership have all closed, the last of them in 2024. Support for Liberia's electronic medical records, laboratory information system, disease surveillance reporting and DHIS2 warehouse is now planned through the December 2025 memorandum instead.

### China activities

No Chinese-financed digital infrastructure, network-equipment supply or bilateral digital agreement was on the record for Liberia as at August 2026.

### EU activities

The European Union's one Liberia-specific treaty instrument turns on a database, and the Commission has moved to end it. Under the FLEGT voluntary partnership agreement Liberia undertook to build a legality assurance system and a timber chain-of-custody database, whose rollout plan and milestone grid to 2018 the second joint implementation committee adopted in June 2015. The licensing target then slipped across successive meetings: the fourth committee recorded that in some areas the work was not on track (September 2016) and the fifth put licensing as then targeted for 2020 (April 2017). In September 2025 the Commission proposed terminating the agreement after a decade without an operative licensing scheme - a proposal, not an adopted termination.

EU money does reach Liberian digital infrastructure, through a continental programme rather than a bilateral one: the Meteosat Third Generation receiving station installed at Roberts International Airport in October 2025 was EU-funded under ClimSA and fitted under African Union Commission contract.

The other European parties in the digital estate are commercial. Liberia's National Port Authority signed a smart-ports memorandum of understanding with the French port operator HAROPA in July 2026 to digitise state port operations, and the national identity rollout runs as a concession under which OSD finances enrolment and card

issuance and later transfers the system to government, which President Boakai chose over a conventional procurement (August 2026). No adequacy finding or GDPR-alignment arrangement was on the record for Liberia as at August 2026.

### Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf-financed data centre, operator equity holding or bilateral digital agreement with a Gulf state was on the record for Liberia as at August 2026.

### India activities

No India Stack-derived deployment, Indian digital financing or bilateral digital agreement with India was on the record for Liberia as at August 2026.

### Digital sovereignty

The Nairobi firm that built Liberia's national identity system withheld full database access from the registry over an unpaid balance (March 2026), and the build-operate-transfer concession signed with Austria's OeSD International to replace it awaits ratification by the Legislature (September 2026). The registry's executive director says identity data remains a national asset under Liberian control, and that the concession carries training and technology transfer so the state can run the system without permanent dependence on the company. The terms on which the OeSD concession and the data-sharing agreement under the December 2025 health memorandum with the United States govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026.

Where data must sit is set sector by sector. The telecoms regulator's cybersecurity regulations of January 2026 require telecommunications providers to store personal data primarily inside Liberia and to keep an in-house cybersecurity unit so that primary defence against cyber threats is in Liberia, alongside the Central Bank's hosting rule for payment systems. The unenacted National Data Governance Policy of March 2026 would define strategic and sensitive categories of data with their own storage and transfer rules, keep public-sector data subject to Liberian law wherever it is stored, and host the identity registry's and revenue authority's data in the National Data Center at the state operator LTC-Mobile and in localised cloud such as a Tier III+ facility being built in Buchanan, in line with the AU Data Policy Framework. No instrument fixing where state data is held or under whose law it is processed was in force as at September 2026.

The payment switch is the core system the state runs itself: the Central Bank operates the instant payment system it regulates, holding the settlement accounts, built on the open-source Mojaloop platform.

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